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EU AI Act France

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AI & Partners defends and extends the digital rights of users at risk around the world. By combining direct technical support, comprehensive policy engagement, global advocacy, grassroots professional services, regulatory interventions, and participating in industry groups such as AI Commons, we fight for fundamental rights in the artificial intelligence age.

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Who Are We

AI That You Can Trust

Why Us?

Stay on the right side of history. At AI & Partners, we believe AI should unlock potential—not cause harm. We’ve seen the fear and fallout when teams lose control of AI, but also the trust and innovation that follow when it’s handled responsibly. That’s why we exist: to help you build AI you can trust and stand behind—for the long run.

80%

of AI systems
are unknown

What Do We Do?

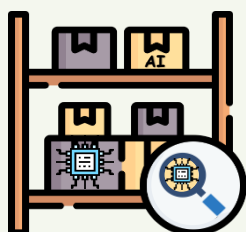
We enable safe AI usage—for your organization and your clients. Unknown AI adoption leads to confusion, risk, and reputational damage. We help you take control with tools to identify, monitor, and govern all AI systems—so you're not reacting to AI, you're leading it.



How Do We Do It?

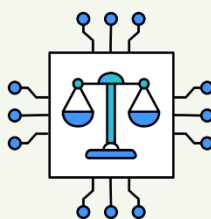
Do you know what AI systems you have? Identify all known and unknown AI systems (algorithms, LLMs, prompts, and models) from all internal and external AI vendors, automated by generating your inventory. Overall, 80% of AI inventory is unknown to our clients.

How do you guarantee ongoing safe AI use? Continuously monitor deployed AI systems for performance drift, anomalies or failures, real-world impacts, and emerging risks (e.g. data poisoning). Any malfunction of an AI system has severe implications for organisations (e.g. inability to assess online misinformation that leads to widespread public mistrust), so monitoring becomes a matter of urgency.



AI Discovery & AI Inventory

Automatically detect all AI systems, including models, algorithms, and prompts, and maintain a live, always-updated register for full visibility and compliance.



Responsible AI

Embed fairness, transparency, and control into every stage of AI use—aligning with the EU AI Act and building ‘Trustworthy-by-Design’.



Model Monitoring

Continuously track your AI models after deployment to detect drift, bias, or failure—so you stay in control and prevent harm before it happens.



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Overview

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is rapidly transforming societies and economies, and France has positioned itself as a leader in steering this transformation through a pragmatic, sovereignty-conscious, and innovation-led approach. Anchored in the France 2030 strategy, France embraces AI as a pillar of national competitiveness and technological independence, while fully aligning its regulatory framework with the European Union's AI Act, directly applicable gradually since August 1, 2024.

Rather than pursuing standalone national legislation, France complements EU regulation with sector-specific initiatives, mission-driven funding, and strategic oversight structures to ensure responsible, inclusive, and future-ready AI deployment. At the heart of this model lies a commitment to human-centric and explainable AI, supported by coordinated governance, institutional capacity-building, and a dynamic public-private innovation ecosystem.

France's AI governance framework is grounded in the National AI Strategy (Phase 2, 2021–2025), backed by €2.22 billion in public funding. This strategy advances three pillars: skills and talent development, scientific excellence, and economic scaling. Over half of the public investment is dedicated to education, upskilling, and the expansion of AI-focused research and academic tracks. Strategic sectoral deployment is a hallmark of France's approach. Programmes like *Confiance.ai*, *IA Booster France 2030*, and *DIAC/DIAT* target AI integration in high-impact domains—ranging from aerospace and energy to health, defense, and ecological transition. A flagship focus is on embedded, edge AI systems, supported by more than €635 million, positioning France as a global leader in smart, low-energy, and privacy-preserving AI.

France's AI governance structure reflects a layered and distributed model. It is anchored by the CNIL (Commission nationale de l'informatique et des libertés), which has established a dedicated Artificial Intelligence Service and published an AI Action Plan to provide operational guidance, particularly around GDPR compliance, DPIAs, and privacy-by-design practices.

France is also introducing an amendment to its Intellectual Property Code to address copyright issues linked to AI-generated content.

France does not currently plan to enact standalone AI legislation. Instead, it leverages existing national laws (e.g., the Law for a Digital Republic, competition law, cybersecurity frameworks) in tandem with the EU AI Act. The Generative AI Committee, launched in 2023, further exemplifies France's intention to stay at the forefront of AI ethics, innovation, and policy coordination.

Governance of AI policy in France is led by a national AI coordinator and the *Secrétariat général pour l'investissement (SGPI)*, working across ministries and agencies such as Inria, CEA, CNRS, and the Ministry for Higher Education and Research. Together, these bodies manage programmes, scale innovation, and ensure coherence with broader France 2030 missions. This approach enables a cooperative governance framework that involves academia, SMEs, large enterprises, and territorial authorities. Regional innovation is bolstered through the 3IA Institutes in Paris, Nice, Grenoble, and Toulouse, and through territorial demonstrators that act as testbeds for real-world AI integration.

France is a strong advocate for EU-wide harmonization and plays a leading role in international AI governance initiatives. The country contributes actively to platforms such as the OECD, UNESCO, and the Global Partnership on AI (GPAI), and is committed to upholding and shaping global norms around ethical, democratic, and sovereign AI systems. France's contributions to European digital commons, open-source model development, and its support for interoperability and responsible AI standards reflect its dual ambition: strategic autonomy within Europe and leadership in global AI policy dialogues.

France supports a vibrant AI innovation ecosystem, with over 1000 AI startups and dedicated programmes to accelerate commercialization, IP creation, and scale-up. Initiatives like *Startups et PME Innovantes*, *Technological Maturation of Embedded AI*, and *Digital Commons for Generative AI* strengthen France's position in sovereign capability-building and industrial AI development.

Clusters such as Saclay and Sophia Antipolis, along with national innovation banks like *Bpifrance*, provide access to funding, compute infrastructure, and industrial partnerships—ensuring that AI ventures have the resources to thrive in both domestic and international markets.





Skills, Compute Infrastructure, and Future Preparedness

A cornerstone of France's AI strategy is workforce development, with more than €800 million invested in AI training, doctoral funding, and interdisciplinary education. Special focus is placed on inclusion, gender parity, and lifelong learning to ensure broad access to AI careers.

On the infrastructure side, France is enhancing its HPC (High-Performance Computing) capacity and developing sovereign hardware-software stacks for edge computing, green AI, and secure embedded systems. These developments aim to ensure technological resilience and reduce dependence on non-European infrastructure.

France launched "Osez l'IA" on 1 July 2025, as part of its national strategy to integrate artificial intelligence across all types of businesses, especially small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs and ETIs). The plan builds on the 2018 National AI Strategy and aligns with the France 2030 vision, led by Clara Chappaz (Minister Delegate for AI and Digital), with the goal of promoting responsible, accessible, and tangible AI adoption nationwide.

The initiative has ambitious 2030 targets: achieve 100 % AI adoption among large corporations, 80 % among SMEs/ETIs, and 50 % among micro-enterprises/ It is structured around three pillars:

Awareness & outreach, via a network of 300 AI ambassadors, monthly business events, and a citizen consultation on ethical AI.

Training, through the launch of an "AI Academy" by the end of 2025 offering modules for workers, jobseekers, and leaders, aiming to train 15 million professionals by 2030

Support & funding, via co-financed "Data AI diagnostics" (covering 40% of costs), a catalogue of AI solutions, and France 2030 calls for proposals like "AI generative uses" and "AI Pioneers"

The French government has allocated substantial public funding (officially part of the France 2030 programme), including diagnostics finance, accelerator schemes, guaranteed loans, and support for high-potential projects, with €200 million earmarked for diagnostics alone and further support in acceleration programmes. Expected impacts include a 20% increase in productivity for AI-adopting firms and a significant reduction in the adoption gap; 13 % of SMEs currently use AI, with the goal of reaching 80 % by 2030. For more details, see the official site:

<https://www.economie.gouv.fr/actualites/osez-lia-un-plan-pour-diffuser-lia-dans-toutes-les-entreprises>

Conclusion: A Model of Mission-Oriented, Trusted AI for Europe

Through a balanced model of EU alignment, national strategic investment, and global ethical leadership, France is cultivating a resilient, human-centric, and competitive AI ecosystem. The country's commitment to sovereignty, sectoral excellence, and democratic values places it among the foremost AI-ready nations in Europe, with a strong foundation to influence the global future of trustworthy and inclusive AI.





Specific AI Governance or Law

France adopts a hybrid AI governance model, combining EU-level rules with national initiatives. Aligned with the EU AI Act (effective August 2024), it adds sectoral programs and CNIL-led guidance. CNIL's AI Action Plan supports responsible AI, while France 2030 fosters innovation in key sectors like embedded systems and generative AI.

Specific AI Governance in France

Rather than enacting standalone, comprehensive national legislation, France has embraced a hybrid governance model that combines EU-level regulation with domestic sector-specific initiatives. Central to this strategy is the alignment with the EU AI Act, providing a harmonized regulatory baseline across the European Union. At the national level, France complements this framework with targeted initiatives, legislative proposals, and institutional support mechanisms. A notable example is the Artificial Intelligence Service established by the CNIL (Commission nationale de l'informatique et des libertés), France's data protection authority. The CNIL has released an AI Action Plan and accompanying "how-to sheets" designed to guide organisations in the responsible development and deployment of AI systems, with an emphasis on privacy and data protection. France's National AI Strategy, developed under the broader France 2030 initiative, focuses on building competitive AI research capacity and embedding AI across critical sectors. Sector-specific programmes such as IA Booster France 2030, DIAC, and DIAT encourage trusted and demonstrable AI use cases in fields like embedded systems, territorial innovation, and generative AI technologies.

AI Ethics Guidelines and Sectoral Governance Tools

In the absence of AI-specific national legislation, France leverages a constellation of sectoral frameworks and evolving guidance to uphold ethical and legal standards in AI. Key developments include: A proposed amendment to the French Intellectual Property Code (IPC), aimed at protecting artists and authors in the context of AI-generated content. The CNIL's evolving guidance on data governance in AI, including requirements for data minimisation, lawful processing, and Data Protection Impact Assessments (DPIAs). Existing legislation, including the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), competition law, civil liability rules, and the Law for a Digital Republic, which indirectly shape the development and use of AI in France. These instruments collectively ensure that ethical considerations—such as transparency, fairness, and accountability—are integrated into AI design and deployment, even in the absence of a national, horizontal AI law.

Proposed AI Regulatory Authority and Future Outlook

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Discussion: France's National AI Strategy

'France's AI governance strategy is grounded in an investment-driven, sovereignty-conscious framework that emphasizes sectoral transformation, research excellence, and trusted AI adoption. Operationalized through mission-led programmes under France 2030, it encourages the responsible development and deployment of AI through national coordination, economic scaling, and public-private collaboration.'

**Research
Specialisation**

Qualification

Education

Inclusion

Analysis

France's national AI strategy embraces a pragmatic and innovation-centric vision, aligning closely with key principles such as trust, explainability, efficiency, and sovereignty. Unlike jurisdictions such as Singapore, which emphasize a principles-based, voluntary approach, France pursues a mission-oriented, investment-heavy model—anchored in France 2030—to build institutional capacity, develop AI talent, and accelerate the integration of AI into strategic sectors. This reflects France's broader ambition to become a world leader in embedded, frugal, and trustworthy AI by 2025. The second phase of the National AI Strategy (2021–2025), with a budget of €2.22 billion, focuses on three pillars: skills and talent development, economic deployment, and scientific advancement. Over half of public funding is allocated to AI education and training, aiming to address talent shortages through new academic tracks, interdisciplinary programmes, and international recruitment initiatives. The strategy also aims to scale sovereign technologies, with emphasis on AI embedded at the edge, privacy-preserving AI, and green AI solutions.

France's strategy empowers institutions like Inria, CNRS, and CEA to coordinate AI research, while aligning with EU-level priorities. It leverages existing public-private partnerships, such as the Confiance.ai programme, and fosters regional innovation through 3IA Institutes in Grenoble, Paris, Nice, and Toulouse. A hallmark of the strategy is its sectoral targeting. France prioritizes strategic verticals including aerospace, automotive, energy, and Industry 4.0, with demonstrator projects and AI deployment incentives in each. For example, embedded AI is seen as a core growth engine, with €635 million dedicated to positioning France among global leaders in edge AI technologies. Similar support mechanisms are provided for AI in ecological transition, health, and security applications.

France's approach distributes AI governance across multiple stakeholders, coordinated by the National AI Coordinator and the Secrétariat général pour l'investissement (SGPI). The governance model draws on the French Tech ecosystem, innovation alliances, and industry consortia, ensuring that public research excellence is matched by private sector scaling capacity. Rather than fixed role-based obligations, the strategy promotes shared accountability across research bodies, startups, major enterprises, and territorial actors. This supports a cooperative governance model, enabling flexible adaptation to sector-specific needs and risk profiles.

France's strategy incorporates a risk-sensitive mindset, particularly through its focus on trustworthy AI. Initiatives such as the Grand Défi "Confiance.ai" are structured to ensure AI systems meet standards for safety, auditability, and robustness—especially in high-risk, mission-critical domains. The programme also supports industrial readiness for the EU AI Act, positioning France as a key enabler of European AI sovereignty. France also champions ethical and sustainable AI practices, including frugal AI and privacy-centric technologies such as homomorphic encryption, federated learning, and secure enclaves. These investments align with EU-wide efforts and global norms around human-centric and environmentally responsible AI.

The second phase of the strategy emphasizes capacity-building at all levels: from elite research hubs and doctoral programmes to regional incubators and SME support services. Tools such as Scikit-learn—originating from French research—and a growing number of AI startups (over 1000 as 2025 showcase the country's ability to translate academic excellence into practical innovation. Dedicated measures—such as €276 million for nationwide upskilling, and funding for academic-industry accelerators—ensure AI education is accessible and scalable. France also prioritizes gender equity, inclusion, and lifelong learning, recognizing that AI transformation must be socially embedded and democratically governed.





France's Approach to AI Regulation and Governance

France follows a multi-tiered AI governance model, aligning with the EU AI Act from August 2024 while avoiding standalone national laws. It supplements this with sector-specific measures, such as CNIL's AI Action Plan and a proposed IPC amendment on AI-generated works, promoting innovation, legal clarity, and rights-respecting AI deployment.

1. Regulatory and Strategic Frameworks

France's AI governance is shaped by a multi-tiered approach that integrates national innovation strategy with EU-level legal instruments. While France does not currently enforce a standalone, comprehensive AI law, it adheres to the EU AI Act. Instead of duplicating EU efforts, France complements this framework through sector-specific legislative initiatives and policy instruments. Examples include a proposed amendment to the Intellectual Property Code (IPC) addressing AI-generated works and rights ownership, and CNIL's AI Action Plan, which provides practical guidance on ensuring privacy-respectful AI. This approach reflects France's commitment to embedding humanistic and democratic values in AI deployment, while preserving space for innovation and legal clarity across specific domains.



2. Institutional Support and Strategic Missions

France's AI strategy is coordinated through a network of institutions, including the Commission nationale de l'informatique et des libertés (CNIL) and the National AI Strategy task force under the France 2030 initiative. The creation of a national AI coordinator ensures coherence across ministries, enabling inter-agency collaboration and alignment with both economic priorities and societal values. Strategic missions under the National AI Strategy include supporting cutting-edge research, disseminating AI across the economy, and fostering technology demonstrations across priority sectors such as defense, health, energy, and transport. Programmes like IA Booster France 2030 and the Generative AI Committee engage stakeholders to guide ethical and strategic decision-making.

3. Standards Development and Global Engagement

France actively shapes AI-related policies at the European level and contributes to global standard-setting through collaborations within the EU, OECD, and international forums. The CNIL's guidance materials, including AI "how-to" sheets and privacy-by-design recommendations, offer frameworks aligned with GDPR principles and the EU AI Act, enhancing cross-border consistency. Through its participation in EU-level initiatives and contributions to digital commons for generative AI, France seeks to influence the development of interoperable ethical standards that reinforce democratic norms, data sovereignty, and trustworthiness in AI systems.



4. Sectoral and Extended Regulatory Approaches

France employs a sector-led model of AI governance, focusing on domain-specific interventions rather than a blanket regulatory regime. For instance, the proposed IPC amendment addresses copyright concerns specific to creative industries and AI-generated content, while CNIL's efforts emphasize data protection in high-risk sectors like health and education. The flexibility of this model allows tailored oversight that reflects the nuanced risks and opportunities in each domain, while also ensuring that ethical and legal guardrails remain robust. Trusted AI demonstrators and territorial pilots serve as testbeds for evaluating AI impacts under real-life conditions.

5. Fostering Innovation and Indigenous Development

The French government views AI as a pillar of economic sovereignty and digital competitiveness. France's National AI Strategy invests in indigenous capabilities through calls for projects such as Technological Maturation of Embedded AI and Digital Commons for Generative AI, which support the development of sovereign compute infrastructure, datasets, and models. Additionally, France's ambition to position three universities among the world's top 50 in AI reflects its focus on nurturing research excellence and deep-tech innovation. This strategy encourages homegrown startups, facilitates IP creation, and builds resilience in the face of global AI competition.

6. AI in Public Sector Transformation

Public sector transformation is integral to France's AI vision. Through programmes operated by entities like Banque des Territoires and Bpifrance, AI is deployed to address regional development, infrastructure management, and public service delivery. These projects focus on trust, explicability, and safety—especially for high-stakes applications in transportation and security.

7. AI Skills, Education and Inclusion

France's AI policy highlights the importance of talent development and education in sustaining a competitive AI ecosystem. The national strategy calls for internationally ranked training institutions, with students and professionals encouraged to pursue expertise in data science, machine learning, and robotics. Public funding supports upskilling programmes, university-industry partnerships, and training platforms that democratize AI education. These efforts aim to reduce digital divides and promote inclusion by ensuring AI benefits reach everyone.

8. Infrastructure, Compute and Data Foundations

France is investing in the infrastructure needed to support responsible AI innovation, including support for embedded AI systems, edge computing architectures, and open digital commons. Projects like IA-cluster and DIAC fund research into trusted AI systems, with a strong emphasis on robustness, safety, and ethical design. CNIL also promotes secure, privacy-preserving data practices through GDPR-aligned recommendations and DPIA frameworks. These foundations are key to enabling scalable, high-quality AI systems that serve both public and private sector needs.





France's Approach to Fostering AI Innovation

'France's AI strategy is rooted in sovereign capability-building, sectoral transformation, and global competitiveness. Through a structured national plan backed by substantial investment under France 2030, the country focuses on embedding AI in strategic sectors, developing cutting-edge research capacity, and ensuring ethical and trusted AI aligned with European values. France positions itself as a leader in embedded, frugal, and secure AI systems.'

1. Unlocking Economic Value through Targeted AI Deployment

France's National AI Strategy aims to generate economic and societal value by integrating AI into key national priority sectors. These include healthcare, energy, defense, industry, and ecological transition. Programmes like Confiance.ai and DIAC promote adoption in mission-critical domains, while the strategy explicitly supports embedded AI for smart manufacturing and edge computing. France also targets strategic verticals—such as aerospace and automotive—where AI can reinforce industrial leadership and global competitiveness.



2. Catalysing Innovation through Strategic Clustering and Ecosystems

France fosters AI innovation through a national network of 3IA Institutes in Grenoble, Paris, Nice, and Toulouse. These regional centers bring together academic, industrial, and public actors to accelerate innovation and tech transfer. Alongside hubs like Saclay and Sophia Antipolis, the government funds industrial demonstrators and experimentation platforms to catalyze real-world impact. These efforts are supported by Bpifrance and regional authorities, creating dense ecosystems that promote deep tech growth and AI deployment.

3. Enabling Trusted and Responsible Data Use

France's AI strategy strongly emphasizes trust, with a specific focus on GDPR compliance, privacy-by-design principles, and sovereign data infrastructure. Through CNIL's AI Action Plan and initiatives under France 2030, the country promotes privacy-preserving technologies such as federated learning, homomorphic encryption, and secure data enclaves. These capabilities support data sharing while safeguarding fundamental rights, in line with European digital sovereignty and ethical AI goals.

4. Scaling AI in the Public Sector

The French government leads by example, deploying AI in public services and administrative modernization. Public agencies are encouraged to integrate AI into health diagnostics, energy optimization, mobility, and digital inclusion. Projects like Demonstrators of Artificial Intelligence in Territories (DIAT) foster innovation at local and regional levels, promoting AI adoption that is sensitive to community needs and socioeconomic diversity.



5. Advancing Compute and Research Infrastructure

France is investing heavily in high-performance computing (HPC), AI chips, and edge AI architectures. With over €635 million dedicated to embedded AI and compute innovation, the country is building sovereign technical infrastructure to reduce reliance on foreign technologies. Research excellence is coordinated through institutions such as Inria, CEA, and CNRS, which support breakthroughs in symbolic AI, neural networks, and next-gen AI systems.

6. Empowering SMEs and Startups

France recognizes the strategic role of startups and SMEs in building a competitive AI ecosystem. Programmes like IA Booster France 2030 and Startups et PME innovantes provide financial, technical, and commercialization support. France's 500+ AI startups benefit from government incentives, public procurement opportunities, and links to academic research, fostering faster scale-up and global expansion.

AI now accounts for 30% of French venture capital investment. Major French AI fundraisings include Mistral AI (€1.2B), Poolside (€526M), H (€250M), Potoroom (€62M), Aqemia (€60M), Bioptimus (€40M), Flex.AI (€35M), and DUST (€16M). France now counts 16 AI-related unicorns. Recent notable exits include Preligens (acquired by Safran), Datakalab (by Apple), and LightOn's public listing in Paris, highlighting the sector's growth.

7. Developing a Future-Ready Workforce

To address AI-related talent shortages, France allocates over €800 million to education and upskilling initiatives. The strategy expands AI-focused academic tracks, increases doctoral scholarships, and supports AI Chairs in priority domains. Special attention is paid to interdisciplinary training, promoting convergence between AI, law, ethics, and engineering. The government also supports gender diversity and inclusion in AI fields to ensure a broad and equitable talent pipeline.



8. Aligning AI Innovation with Sustainability Goals

France is integrating AI into its ecological transition goals, using it to optimize energy consumption, decarbonize industry, and improve environmental monitoring. The strategy encourages frugal AI models that reduce energy usage, and incentivizes the development of green infrastructure, including sustainable data centers and low-energy embedded systems. AI is also being used to improve biodiversity management and climate resilience.

9. Building Public Trust and Ethical AI

Trust and explainability are central to France's AI strategy. The government funds initiatives like Confiance.ai to ensure AI systems used in industry are auditable, transparent, and aligned with ethical norms. CNIL provides oversight and publishes guidance on data protection in AI systems. France also emphasizes the responsibility of actors across the AI value chain—developers, deployers, and users—to ensure compliance and transparency.

According to barometer du numerique run by l'[Agence Nationale de la Cohésion des Territoires](#), 56% of French people have no confidence in artificial intelligence, with 21% expressing strong distrust. However, the distrust of artificial intelligence decreases with personal use. People using AI for the personal or professional purpose are significantly more confident than those who have not used it.

Men show more confidence in artificial intelligence than women (45% vs. 38%). Distrust also rises with age, as 70% of those 70+ are sceptical compared to 38% of people aged 18-24. Younger generations are clearly more optimistic than their elders about the impact of artificial intelligence.



AI is mostly perceived as a threat in the employment and artistic creation sectors, while the points of view regarding the impact on the environment and sustainable development remain divided. In the field of education and training in 2024, AI is slightly more often perceived as an opportunity (50%), although a significant number of respondents (47%) still see it as a threat.

10. Shaping Global AI Governance and Standards

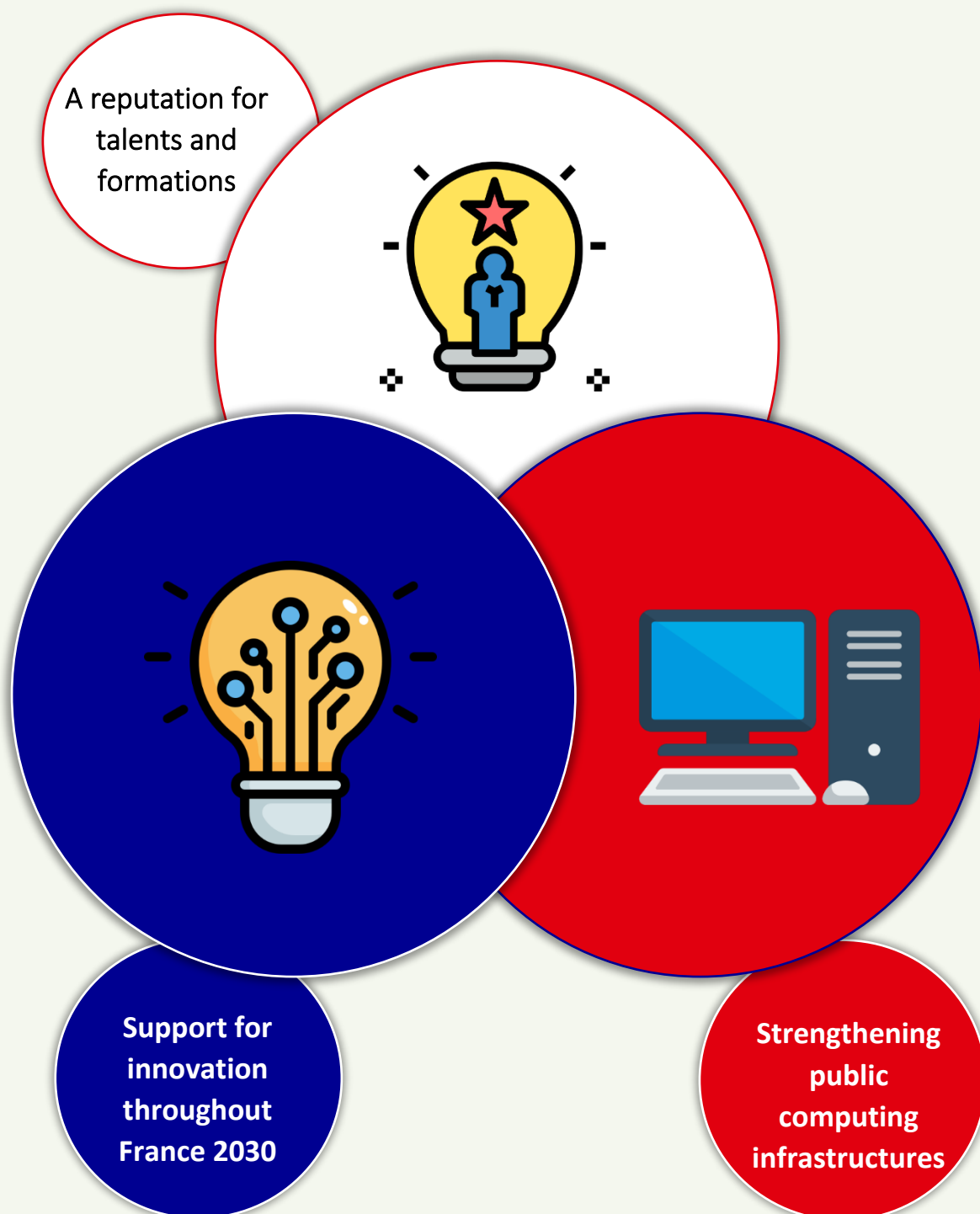
France plays an active role in global AI governance, both through EU leadership in the AI Act and participation in international fora such as the OECD, UNESCO, and the Global Partnership on AI (GPAI). The strategy supports the development of open-source tools, interoperable standards, and European digital commons to ensure ethical and sovereign AI ecosystems. France's commitment to European alignment strengthens its role as a global thought leader in responsible AI governance.

France's AI strategy drives sovereign innovation, sectoral deployment, and ethical AI through major investments in research, infrastructure, and skills—positioning the country as a global leader in trusted, embedded AI.





Figure 1: Core Pillars of French AI Strategy





Digital Decade 2025: Country Report

Artificial Intelligence (AI) stands at the forefront of France's digital policy priorities. This commitment is reflected in its national AI strategy, the organization of the AI Action Summit, and the integration of new initiatives into its updated roadmap. Throughout 2024, France focused on cultivating AI ecosystems, positioning the government as a reliable intermediary to promote and support the deployment of AI solutions. To facilitate this, the country is preparing adoption guides that include regulatory insights and demonstrate successful business cases to encourage wider use of AI.

In May 2024, the President announced the awarding of nine new AI cluster projects through a national call for expressions of interest. These clusters are research and training centers for AI, backed by €360 million from the France 2030 investment plan. Also in 2024, the government initiated a project call titled "Accelerating the Use of Generative AI in the Economy" to drive enterprise adoption of AI technologies. According to the 2025 Eurobarometer, 79% of French citizens believe public authorities should actively guide the development of AI and other digital technologies to ensure alignment with societal values and rights—a 9 percentage point increase from the previous year, highlighting growing public engagement on the matter.

France's updated roadmap includes two key new initiatives to enhance AI integration. First is the "Accelerating the Uses of Generative AI in the Economy" call for projects, part of the France 2030 plan. This aims to foster the development of targeted generative AI tools by connecting technology developers with end users, following on from the "Digital Commons of Generative AI" initiative, which focused on building foundational, open-source AI technologies and demonstrating their economic potential. The selection of project winners is expected in 2025. Second is the release of a practical guide for implementing retrieval-augmented generation (RAG), a method that enhances generative AI with company-specific data without retraining.

The 3IA network, launched in 2019, has funded over 40 chairs and 300 doctoral contracts. Building on this, the €360 million AI Clusters program is creating 9 hubs to boost AI training and research, aiming by 2030 to train 100,000 people—including 20,000 through continuing education—and place at least one institution among the world's best.

Published by the Directorate-General for Enterprises in November 2024, the guide outlines use cases, technical requirements, cost considerations, and implementation advice to support adoption across businesses and local authorities. In line with 2024 policy recommendations, France has reviewed and diversified its approach to promoting advanced digital technologies, especially AI and cloud services. The country continues to foster local innovation ecosystems to encourage technology diffusion and has drawn on insights from the national AI Commission to develop further strategies.

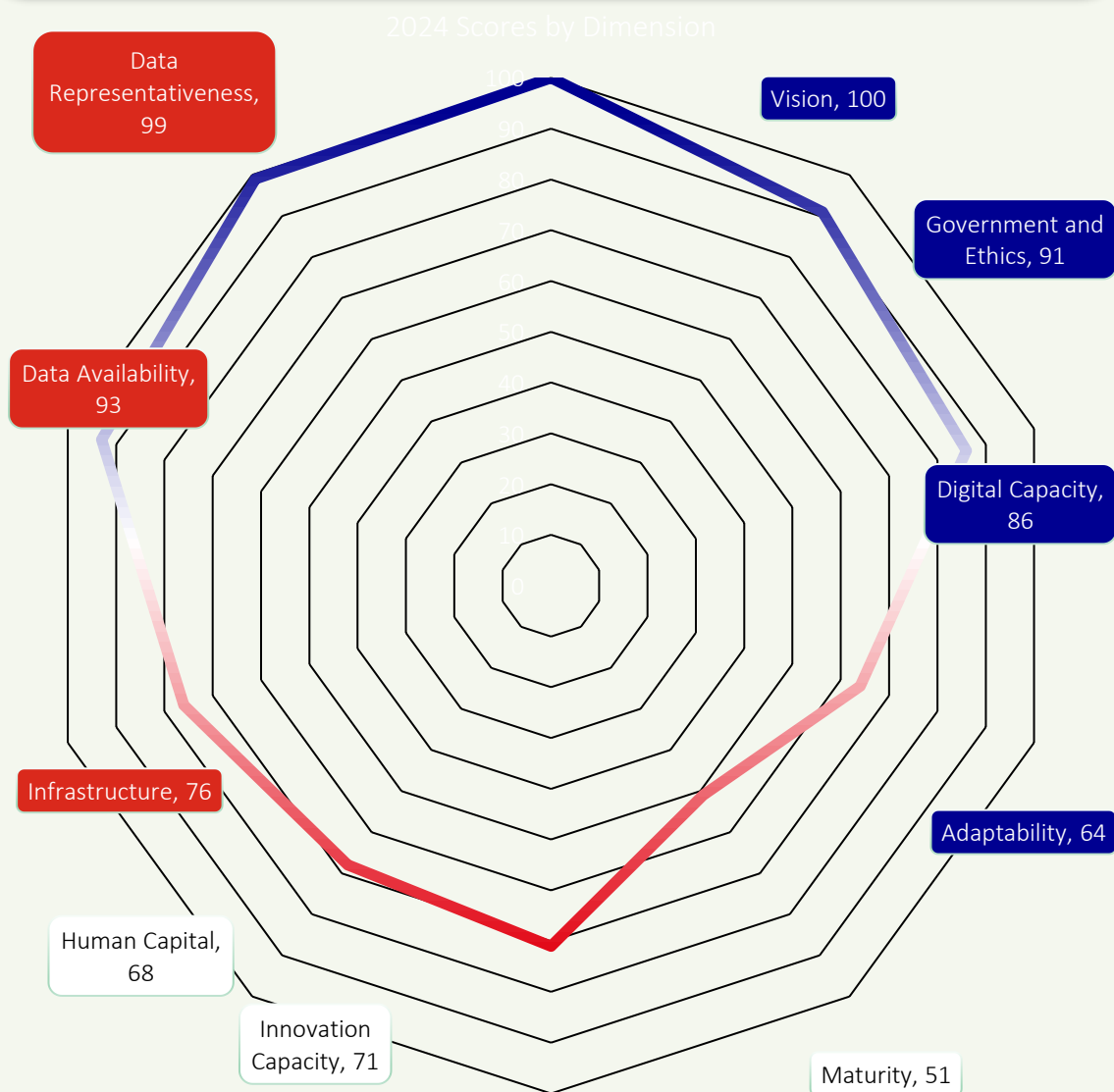
France hosted the AI Action Summit in Paris in February 2025 and will be home to a forthcoming EU AI factory. At the summit, the EU announced plans to invest €200 billion in AI gigafactories and data centers, including the AI Factory France (AI2F). The majority of funding—€150 billion—will come from the European AI Champions Initiative, with the remaining €50 billion provided by the EU itself. During the summit, 60 countries endorsed a declaration promoting ethical, inclusive, and open AI, advocating global dialogue, fair competition, and sustainability. Additionally, the French AI firm Mistral AI introduced its generative AI platform "Le Chat," intended to compete with non-European offerings like ChatGPT and DeepSeek. Preceding the summit, the French President announced €109 billion in private investments for AI development in France, largely aimed at building data centers. Key contributors include the United Arab Emirates, planning a 1GW-capacity data center as part of Europe's largest AI campus, and Canada's Brookfield, which pledged €20 billion—€15 billion of which is designated for new data centers by 2030.





Government AI Readiness by Oxford Insights

Western Europe ranks as the highest-performing region in this year's Government AI Readiness Index, with five countries in the global top 10. France leads the regional ranking with a score of 79.36, narrowly ahead of the United Kingdom (78.88), followed closely by the Netherlands (77.23), Germany (76.90), and Finland (76.48). With an average regional score of 69.56, Western Europe outperforms the global average (47.59) across all three pillars of Government, Technology, and Data & Infrastructure. The region's standout strength is the Data & Infrastructure pillar, where it averages 81.91, more than 21 points above the global benchmark (59.62), reflecting its advanced digital infrastructure and high-quality data environment. Although a few microstates such as San Marino, Liechtenstein, and Andorra fall slightly below the global average in the Government pillar, Western Europe's dominance at the top of the index underscores its continued leadership in AI readiness.





Government

France scores 85.29 in the Government pillar, reflecting its strong national commitment to AI as a lever for competitiveness, sovereignty, and public innovation. While it does not currently have a standalone AI law, France aligns with the EU AI Act, applicable from August 2024. Its AI governance is embedded in sector-specific legislation, strategic initiatives, and data protection oversight—particularly through the CNIL, which plays a central role via its AI Action Plan and dedicated Artificial Intelligence Service. The National AI Strategy, launched under "France 2030," prioritizes ethical, explainable, and secure AI development. France's approach is highly coordinated, involving multiple ministries, research agencies, and industrial partners to drive trustworthy AI adoption across sectors. The recent establishment of the Generative AI Committee underscores France's intent to lead on both innovation and regulation in this emerging field.

Technology Sector

France scores 63.53 in the Technology pillar, reflecting its growing but uneven AI innovation ecosystem. The country has invested heavily in R&D, with initiatives like IA Booster France 2030, DIAC, and DIAT supporting AI experimentation and real-world deployment in critical sectors such as defense, health, and transport. University-driven clusters and calls for embedded AI projects contribute to deep-tech advancement, while initiatives such as the IA-cluster programme aim to place French institutions among the global AI elite. However, challenges remain in scaling AI startups, fostering sustained entrepreneurial momentum, and accelerating private-sector AI commercialization. The government's increasing emphasis on trusted and explainable AI models signals a strong pivot toward responsible innovation, backed by public funding and cross-sector collaboration.



Data & Infrastructure

France achieves a high score of 89.25 in the Data & Infrastructure pillar, showcasing strong capabilities in digital infrastructure, data governance, and compute capacity. The CNIL plays a key role in shaping responsible data use, supporting AI stakeholders through guidance on GDPR compliance, DPIAs, and privacy-preserving design. France's commitment to data sovereignty and secure data environments is evident in national platforms that facilitate ethical AI experimentation. Ongoing investment in compute infrastructure and the integration of AI into sectors such as healthcare and education further consolidate France's position as a European leader in AI readiness. The country's forward-leaning approach to open data, embedded intelligence, and public-private data-sharing frameworks underpins a robust foundation for the scalable and ethical deployment of AI solutions.



Conclusion

France's artificial intelligence ecosystem is entering a decisive phase—poised to consolidate strategic investment, scientific leadership, and regulatory alignment into measurable national and European impact. Guided by its National AI Strategy (under France 2030), and reinforced by a growing body of institutional and sectoral programmes, France has crafted an AI vision grounded in technological sovereignty, trust, and industrial transformation. Initiatives like Confiance.ai, the 3IA Institutes, and sectoral demonstrators in defense, ecological transition, and healthcare signal France's ambition to lead in embedding ethical and high-performance AI across society and the economy.

Yet, structural challenges remain. As highlighted in government assessments and global readiness indexes, France must bridge the gap between cutting-edge research and widespread adoption—particularly among SMEs and regional actors. While France boasts over 1000 AI startups in 2025, (including Mistral AI, H Company, Poolside, as well as applications such as Alan, Pigment, Doctolib) and strong academic clusters, commercial scalability, procurement access, and late-stage innovation remain uneven. Accelerating the translation of public R&D into marketable applications will be essential to fully unlock AI's economic potential, particularly in sectors like mobility, energy, and manufacturing. Infrastructure and compute capacity also require continued strengthening. Although France has committed over €600 million to embedded and sovereign AI technologies, access to scalable GPU infrastructure, AI-optimized chips, and cross-sector data sharing environments still needs expansion. CNIL's leadership in privacy-preserving AI and federated learning creates a sound regulatory foundation—but usability and accessibility of trusted data infrastructure must keep pace with demand, especially in sensitive domains like health and education. From a governance standpoint, France benefits from early alignment with the EU AI Act, applicable from August 2024. Rather than enacting comprehensive national legislation, France has opted for a sector-focused and institutionally distributed model. CNIL plays a central role, complemented by the newly formed Generative AI Committee, and coordination by the national AI lead. The forthcoming copyright reforms under the Intellectual Property Code (IPC) and CNIL's AI Action Plan represent efforts to anticipate emerging challenges—yet legal clarity, guidance for SMEs, and administrative simplicity remain essential for effective national implementation.

Crucially, talent development has been prioritized, with over €800 million committed to AI training, doctoral tracks, and interdisciplinary education. However, shortages persist in applied AI engineering and deployment readiness. France must further scale its workforce development efforts to include mid-career reskilling and vocational pipelines aligned with real-world needs—especially as demand for explainable AI, cybersecurity, and systems-level thinking grows. To realize its long-term vision, France will need to double down on inclusive innovation strategies. This means empowering regional ecosystems through the 3IA network, ensuring equitable access to AI education, and lowering barriers for SMEs and mid-sized firms through programmes like IA Booster. Deepening collaboration across academia, industry, and public services—particularly in public procurement and AI for public good—will be essential to democratize the benefits of AI.

Internationally, France plays a pivotal role in shaping the European and global AI agenda. It is a vocal contributor to multilateral initiatives such as the OECD, UNESCO, and the Global Partnership on AI (GPAI), and is instrumental in steering ethical and interoperable standards through EU mechanisms. France's emphasis on frugal, sovereign, and human-centric AI aligns with its broader positioning as a leader in European digital sovereignty. France has laid the strategic foundation—the next imperative is disciplined execution and inclusive scaling. With continued commitment to ethical design, industrial transformation, and European cooperation, France can shape not only a resilient national AI ecosystem—but also define the character of globally trusted AI.





Appendix A: Expert Vignettes



Ana Catarina De
Alencar

EIT Manufacturing



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“As France positions itself as a leader in disruptive technologies, with initiatives like Osez l’IA accelerating investment in artificial intelligence, it must ensure that innovation remains anchored in democratic values. Technologies capable of interpreting and influencing emotional states, public opinion, and human subjectivity challenge not only individual rights, but also the very conditions of informed consent, civic freedom, and public trust.”

”

Biography

Ana Catarina de Alencar is an international legal counsel specializing in Artificial Intelligence and Data Privacy. She holds a master’s degree in law philosophy and legal theory and has authored several publications on the intersection of AI and law, including the book *Artificial Intelligence, Ethics, and Law* (2021). Currently based in Paris, Ana serves as Head of Legal at EIT Manufacturing, a European Union co-funded innovation initiative. She also coordinates the Global Leadership Network for Brazilian Women in AI Governance, and contributes to international initiatives for trustworthy AI, including Open Ethics AI and the Z-Inspection initiative.

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Teddy Ramanakasina

EY



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“France's AI ecosystem has taken some clear positions recently, combining national innovation strategies with regulatory alignment. A few developments come to mind that could be helpful to include or enrich the narrative: The “Osez l’IA” national plan (July 2024), led by Clara Chappaz, which aims to accelerate AI adoption across SMEs and strategic sectors; The CNIL’s role in AI governance, particularly through its PANAME project on algorithmic transparency and the experimental use of the IBEX bias-detection tool; and The emergence of Fundamental Rights Impact Assessments (FRIA) as a French ethical framing method, now recommended ahead of the EU AI Act’s enforcement.”



”

Biography

Teddy Ramanakasina, Teddy Ramanakasina is a Associate Director in Cybersecurity, AI Governance, and IT Audit, with over 25 years of experience advising Fortune 500 companies, financial institutions, and multinational enterprises on cyber risk, compliance, and governance. Teddy specializes in aligning cybersecurity, AI regulation, and enterprise risk management with business strategy to ensure resilience, compliance, and future readiness.



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Gaëlle Picard-Abezis

Athenia Consulting



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Cyber-humility is not an option. It's a mindset.

"Power without prudence cannot last long," said Jean de La Fontaine.

Artificial intelligence fascinates, automates, amplifies. But it also exposes: our data, our intentions, our decisions.

AI is not just a tool. It's a new attack surface.

It's no longer just cybersecurity that protects AI, AI is now reshaping cybersecurity.

Confidentiality, sovereignty, vigilance: our usage becomes the strongest link... or the weakest.

”

Biography

Gaëlle Picard-Abezis, With over 20 years of experience in IT, she stands out for her ability to develop influence strategies and establish innovative partnerships, with cross-cutting expertise in artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, and economic intelligence. Partner at Open Sezam (a startup specializing in AI and cybersecurity), Senior Advisor at Polycube (AI startup studio) and NanoWords, she oversees projects on AI agent development and fraud prevention. An auditor at IHEDN since 2021, she also serves on the scientific board of Confrontations Europe. As a lecturer at ESILV (Master's in cybersecurity), she is part of the TF1 Expert cohort for AI in 2025. In 2025, she founded Athenia Consulting, a firm dedicated to supporting secure digital transformations.



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Dr. Anino Emuwa

Avandis Consulting



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France, at the heart of the EU, is well placed to drive global AI innovation, combining strong public sector investment support and a dynamic tech ecosystem with a commitment to ethical, inclusive development and international collaboration.



”

Biography

Dr. Anino Emuwa is an international management consultant with extensive corporate board governance expertise a director and Chairman on several boards with over of 25 years of experience. Dr Anino leads Avandis Consulting as the Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director. Its boutique firm provides research-led strategy and leadership advisory services to businesses, leaders and entrepreneurs worldwide. Dr Anino is also the founder of 100 Women @ Davos, a dynamic community made up of extraordinary women leaders dedicated to creating positive change. This initiative born in Davos during the World Economic Forum in 2019, has since become a beacon for inclusive leadership. As a recognized global authority on Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DE&I), Dr Anino partners with organizations to build inclusive cultures and diverse leadership teams. Dr Anino also coaches and mentors senior women executives and entrepreneurs to achieve their full potential. Dr Anino's expertise spans delivering bespoke leadership masterclasses, large-scale training programs, and public speaking on topics including DE&I, emerging technologies. Dr Anino's thought leadership has earned her recognitions as a LinkedIn Top Voice, Champion for Change, Outstanding Global Woman, and Woman in Fintech, among others .



Adriana Neagu

AI Governance



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For the fifth year running, France leads Europe in attracting foreign AI investment, driven by public policies, strong research and industry engagement. As artificial intelligence advances, it is essential for France to maintain a strong focus on ethics and social responsibility. Although France has not yet appointed its authority under the EU AI Act, the CNIL is leading efforts to promote responsible AI by offering guidance in several areas. France is undeniably making advances in AI, but the path ahead is not without obstacles. There are concerns about sustaining long-term innovation, retaining top talent, and closing gaps in infrastructure and research capabilities. Regulatory issues, fragmented European policies, and limited industry-academia collaboration further complicate progress.



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Biography

Adriana Neagu is a seasoned senior professional with 20 years' experience in privacy implementation and legal advisory across industries such as energy, fintech, cosmetics, retail, IT, and telecom, and she is a member of the Bucharest Bar. Adriana specializes in privacy, cyber law, and AI, holding several certifications from IAPP (AIGP, FIP, CIPP/E, CIPP/US, CPIM) and serves on IAPP's Global Training Advisory Board for Privacy and Data Protection. In addition to her law degree, she completed the data protection programme at Solvay Brussels School of Economics & Management and is a certified adult trainer.



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Wissem Addoun

Franklin Law Firm



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France takes a pragmatic approach to responsible AI, prioritizing GDPR alignment, strong human oversight and CNIL guidance, to translate the AI Act into practice while safeguarding both trust and innovation.



”

Biography

Wissem Addoun is an attorney specialized in Digital law, Data Protection and AI. He advises leading international companies on complex compliance strategies and digital transformation.



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Perrine Pelletier

DATAVALAW Selarl



“

France has emerged as a European AI leader, boosted by the AI Action Summit (Paris, Feb. 2025), including announcement of a €109 billion national plan, and €150 billion in private investments, as well as strong commitment for research and training with the national AI strategy (SNIA).

The ecosystem is thriving, with 1,000+ startups and nearly €2 billion raised in 2024, and 30% of VC funding dedicated to AI. France counts an emblematic AI frontrunner with Mistral AI valued at nearly €12 billion after ASML's €1.3 billion investment.

Yet France still lags in compute sovereignty. Infrastructure remains limited, investments trail U.S./China, and reliance on non-European chipmakers underscores structural vulnerabilities.

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Biography

Perrine Pelletier, Founder of the firm, Perrine Pelletier recently contributed to the drafting of the Code of Conduct for General-Purpose AI for the European Commission's AI Office. She also supports GESTE, where she leads a legal task force on generative AI, and she advised the Alliance de la presse d'information générale in its landmark negotiations with Google and Meta (Facebook) for the first implementation agreements on press publishers' neighbouring rights in Europe.

An expert in innovation law, Perrine Pelletier brings added value in comparative law and works in French, English, German, and Spanish. Driven by a commitment to fair digitalisation, her strengths lie in creativity, attentiveness, vision, and a passion for technology. She regularly contributes to press articles and academic conferences.



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